name and a background as a management consultant in Washington DC to back her up, but her journey on the ground in Indian logistics began with a 50-sq. ft. office and a 620-sq. ft. warehouse. "As a first-time entrepreneur, going to the bathroom between two trucks for years, I learnt so much. Those experiences shaped the way I think about business and my role in it."

Her credibility, she says, did not come from the boardroom but operations. "It came from the boys and girls who were loading our trucks and running machines on the warehouse floor," she says. "After judging me for the first two hours, they didn't care about my gender. They cared about the hard work I was putting in. Once the ground respects you, especially in logistics, there is very little room for management to question you."

Jani's experience, and those of others, shows credibility still has to be earned in an industry where women remain a minority. Women accounted for just 7% of the workforce across 18 NSE-listed logistics companies that reported gender data, according to SheMoves Logistics, a 2025 report by Udaiti Foundation and CII. The number has moved up by just one percentage point in three years. Pertinently, across these 18 companies, 44% had one woman in key management, but none had more than one.



And while daughters in family enterprises have become prominent, Pooja Sharma Goyal, CEO and Founder, Udaiti Foundation, cautions against treating the trend as an industry-wide norm. "A daughter can inherit the business, but she doesn't inherit her father's network along with it," she says.

### BUILD YOUR OWN DOOR

Kanika Tekriwal, founder of private aviation company JetSetGo, exemplifies a leader who built her business without the backing of a family enterprise. She remembers walking into her first sales meeting and being asked if she was there to serve tea and coffee. In other meetings, people would speak to the men around her instead of speaking to her directly.

"When I entered aviation, I was young, I was a woman, and I was entering an industry that was largely dominated by men who had spent decades in it," she says. "In the beginning, I had to prove that I belonged in the room before I could even start talking about the business." Her early years taught her that credibility cannot come from "trying to look like you belong. It has to come from knowing your business better than anyone expects you to". Tekriwal, who graduated in economics from Mumbai University and worked in aviation before setting up JetSetGo, learnt the business from the ground up—aircraft, operations, regulations, economics, main-

## The Gender Gap

**$215 billion**
SIZE OF THE SECTOR

**10.5%**
PROJECTED ANNUAL GROWTH

**13-14%**
CONTRIBUTION TO NATIONAL GDP

**3.2 lakh+**
WORKERS EMPLOYED

**7%**
WOMEN'S SHARE OF THE WORKFORCE ACROSS 18 LISTED LOGISTICS COMPANIES

**1% point**
INCREASE IN WOMEN REPRESENTATION OVER THREE YEARS

**78%**
WOMEN EMPLOYED AS WORKERS; 22% AS EMPLOYEES

**12%**
OPERATIONAL SAVINGS REPORTED FROM CONTRIBUTION BY WOMEN

**CREDIT** SHEMOVES LOGISTICS, A 2025 REPORT BY UDAITI FOUNDATION AND CII.